used to reduce the risk of transmission of infectious agents from body fluids or environmental surface that contain infectious agents.

Health care workers can protect themselves from contact with infectious material or exposure to communicable disease by having knowledge of the infectious process and appropriate barrier protection. Knowledge of Microbiology is an essential component in nursing for practicing disinfection and sterilization to eliminate pathogenic microbes causing infectious disease.

6.2 Immunity

The ability of a host to resist a particular infection or toxins by the action of specific antibodies or sensitized white blood cells produced by them in response to natural exposure of the organism is called as immunity

6.2.1 Immune System

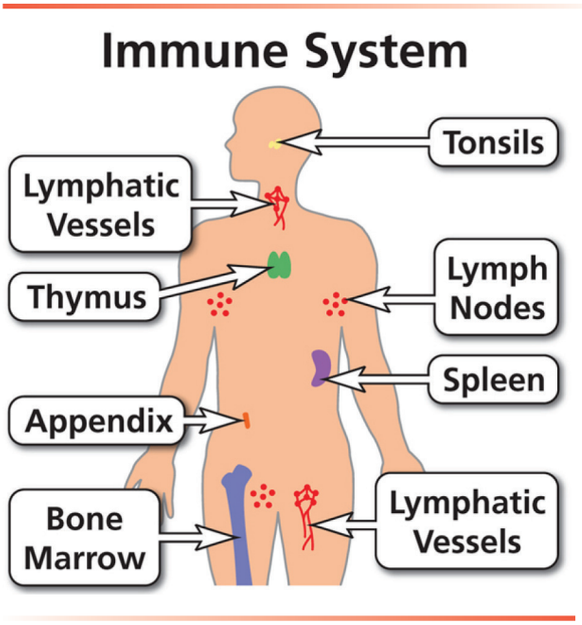
A complex network of specialized cells, tissues, and organs that recognize and defend body from foreign substances. Primarily disease causing microorganism such as bacteria viruses, parasites and fungi.

Lymphoid Organs:

i. PRIMARY LYMPHOID ORGANS – Thymus, Bone Marrow

ii. SECONDARY LYMPHOID ORGANS – Lymph Node, Spleen

These organs produce immune cells or T-cells, B-cells, NK cells, macrophages, leukocytes that help to fight against pathogens.



6.2.2 Factors Influencing the Immune Status of Individual Inherent

Species immunity

Species immunity is that in which a disease affecting one species does not affect the other species (Ex) Human do not contract cattle plague, chicken cholera, while animals are not affected by enteric fever.

Racial immunity:- is that in which various races show marked differences, in their resistance to certain infectious disease.

(Ex) Black Africans affected by a sickle cell anemia (a genetic disease) are resistant to Malaria while Malaria affects other human races.

Individual immunity:-The same racial background and opportunity for exposure some individual of the race experience severe infection. (Ex) Children are more susceptible to disease such as measles, chicken pox while aged individuals are susceptible to pneumonia.

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